



Why is Japan an Attractive Option?

Japan is working towards expanded internationalisation of its educational institutions and work force. The proven reputation of Indian students and educated with their reputation of being excellent and dedicated learners and workers abroad youth enjoys a

Ministry of Education, Science and Culture (counter part of India's Ministry of Human Resource Development) is implementing a comprehensive programme for admitting 100,000 foreign students in Japan's National, State, and Private educational institutions. Special funds are provided to facilitate admittance of foreign students and private universities are given special subsidy based on the number of foreign students they admit.

More and more foreign students are being admitted and the number of Indian students in Japan has also gone up from 203 in 2000 to 410 in 2005. The number is still small compared to for example 2,114 from Malaysia. Japan's higher educational institutions would therefore like to receive many more students from India.

Japan Education Fairs are being organised in India. Many educational intuitions from Japan participate in these fairs.

WHEN TO START THE PREPARATORY WORK

The academic session in most Japanese educational institutions starts on April 1 and ends on March 31 the following year. Most institutions adopt a two-semester system. It is possible to enter some institutions in October. Preparatory home work and search for opportunities has to start well in advance, almost a year ahead of the beginning of the first semester.

HOW TO GET STARTED

Remember admission does not follow financial support, financial support follows admission. It is therefore advisable to look for admission in Japanese institutions of your choice and simultaneously explore financial support.

Acceptance of your candidature at least in principle by a Japanese institution is often a prerequisite for any kind of financial support.

DECIDE THE LEVEL OF STUDY YOU WISH TO PURSUE.

You can study in Japan for Bachelors, Masters, PhD degree or a Technology Degree or join a variety of vocational and technical courses. You can also go to carry out a short term study/research work.

CHECK YOUR PREPAREDNESS STATUS

Having selected the type of institution and subject you will have to find out the names of institutions for you level of study. For the same academic background, different institutions decide on admission on the basis many other factors that show your status of preparedness.

Important factors that will determine which are the institutions in the selected category you have better chances of getting admission are given below:

For PhD or post doctoral work the essential factor is your specialisation and therefore Professors in Japan who may be interested in your area of specialisation is the key factor. Their institutions naturally constitute your short list for further action.

For other degree courses, admission criteria differ from institution to institution and your choice will depend upon what kind of background you have or what is the Status of your preparedness. For example:

Knowledge of Japanese is necessary for some courses and not for other courses. Some intuitions especially those who prefer Japanese Language knowing students take into account performance in a test called Japanese Language Proficiency Test (JLPT) conducted by Japan Foundation in several countries including India

Institutions that offer courses through English medium adopt their own admission criteria on case to case basis.